SFS Annual Report 2025-26 Financial Information

Finance

These notes should be read in conjunction with the annual financial accounts which have been audited.

OUTLINE: In the year ending 31st July 2026, Swindon Film made a loss of £718. This loss is considerably larger than the previous year's and unsustainable in the long-run. The Income & Expenditure Statement (on page 5 of the accounts) presents the figures from the year 2019-20 to enable annual comparisons.

INCOME: The total income for the period was £9,165, which is £67 less that the income in the previous year. Compared with 2024-25, we received £208 less in membership fees and £79 less in ticket sales. We received a slightly lower rate of interest on our investment account and are grateful for the donations received in 2025-26.

SPENDING: Our expenditure of £9,884 was £650 more than the previous year; this was a significant increase. The two biggest costs continue to be the hire of the Arts Centre and paying the film licences. The cost of hiring the theatre has remained constant but, despite careful research by Committee members, the licence fees have increased by £93. There was also a rise of £240 in printing costs as more leaflets were printed in a drive to attract new audiences. Other expenditure has remained fairly constant.

We are grateful to Ian Robertson, retired accountant, who has once again been kind enough to examine our books and sign them off free of charge, also to Richard Turpin for the Website maintenance and Rachel Martin for her artwork and design services.

SUMMARY: Reduced income from membership fees and admissions together with increased licence fees and printing costs were key factors leading to an overall loss in 2025-26. Whilst we still have assets amounting to £10,542, a loss of £718 is obviously not sustainable. We try to keep admission costs at a reasonably competitive level but the Committee agreed that we had to increase the Full season membership by £5 to £85 (making it £6.07 per film) and the Pay as you Go tickets by £1 to £9 and £8 (for concessions) for 2026-27.

We continue to promote Swindon Film and have had encouraging success with sponsorship from local businesses and some grants. It is hoped that this support will lead to a more comfortable financial position by the end of next season.

Rosemary Young
Treasurer, Swindon Film Society